



As your children get older, it gets harder to keep the family together, particularly on vacations. New relationships outside of the family are an important part of growing up.

One way to keep everybody together is to invite the friends along! Here we are on a vacation in the Caribbean with my daughter, Savannah, and her friend. It might cost more, but it's worth it.

The minute your first child is born, it all changes. From now on, you bring your kids with you wherever you go. That means you're going to Disneyland and Canada's Wonderland and all the other money pits designed to put a sparkle in your child's eye (and take the money from your wallet). But you'll do it, because by the time you're planning a Phase Two Vacation, you're building the foundation of family, not just your relationship with your spouse. Children remember vacations and summer sojourns in a special way. Time spent together is a smart investment; it makes your relationship with your kids stronger, fortifying your family as a result.

Money Mistake: *You Want to Have a Bunch of Kids*